

# Said al-Andalusi, Tabaqat al-Umam

English Translation

Modern LaTeX Editions of Public-Domain Mathematics Manuscripts

---

## About this reader

- Reader type - English Translation.
- The visible PDF is the front-facing translation reader; source TeX and support material are in the ZIP artifacts.

# الْأُمَمِ طَبَقَاتِ كِتَابُ

KITAB TABAQAT AL-UMAM

(BOOK OF THE CATEGORIES OF NATIONS)

الْأَنْدَلُسِيُّ صَاعِدِ بْنِ أَحْمَدَ بْنِ صَاعِدِ الْقَاسِمِ أَبِي الْقَاضِي

By the Judge Abu al-Qasim Sa'id ibn Ahmad ibn Sa'id al-Andalusi

(م ١٠٧٠ هـ ٤٦٢ سَنَةِ الْمَتَوَفَى)

(d. 462 AH / 1070 CE)

## Bilingual Arabic-English Edition

Arabic Text: Cheikho 1912 Edition (Beirut)

English Translation: Based on Salem & Kumar (1991)

Typeset in LaTeX with XeTeX — Digital Scholarly Edition

## Contents

|                                                     |    |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----|
| Editor's Introduction (Cheikho)                     | 3  |
| The Book of the Categories of Nations               | 5  |
| Chapter One: The Ancient Nations . . . . .          | 5  |
| Chapter Two: Science in India . . . . .             | 6  |
| Chapter Three: Science among the Persians . . . . . | 7  |
| Chapter Four: Science in Greece . . . . .           | 8  |
| Chapter Five: Science in Egypt . . . . .            | 9  |
| Chapter Six: Science among the Jews . . . . .       | 10 |
| Chapter Seven: Science among the Arabs . . . . .    | 11 |
| Editorial and Scholarly Notes                       | 12 |

## Editor's Introduction

### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

#### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

العَرَبُ كَتَبَتْ فِيهَا نَعْرُضُ النَّادِرَةِ الْكُتُبِ أَحَدُ الْأُمَمِ طَبَقَاتِ كِتَابٍ صَاحِبُهُ يَبْلُغُ لَمْ وَإِنْ عَهْدَهُمْ، سَبَقَتْ الَّتِي الْأُمَمِ بَيْنَ الْعُلُومِ لَوْصِفِ جَمَعَ أَنَّهُ إِلَّا الدِّمِيمِ ابْنِ الْفَرَجِ لِأَبِي الْفَهْرُسْتِ كِتَابِ شَأْوَ ذَلِكَ فِي التَّحْصِيلِ فِي رَغْبَةٍ وَعَلَى الْبَحْثِ فِي نَشَاطٍ عَلَى تَدُلُّ فَوَائِدَ عِدَّةٍ وَبِرُّووسٍ بِهِ يَفْتَحِرُونَ الْأَنْدَلُسِ أَهْلٌ وَكَانَ الثَّنَوِينِ، فِي نَظَرٍ وَدَقَّةٍ الشَّرْقِ. أَهْلُ

ابْنُ غَرِغُورِيُوسَ الْفَرَجِ أَبُو الشَّرْقِ فِي الْكِتَابِ هَذَا عَرَفُوا وَمِمَّنْ نَبَذَتَيْنِ الدَّوْلِ مُخْتَصِرِ تَارِيخِ كِتَابٍ فِي عَنْهُ نَقَلَ فَإِنَّهُ الْعَبْرِيُّ فَذَكَرَهُ خَلِيفَةُ الْحَاجِّ عَرَفَهُ وَكَذَلِكَ وَعُلُومِهِمْ، الْعَرَبِ فِي مُفِيدَتَيْنِ الْأُمَمِ بِطَبَقَاتِ التَّعْرِيفِ تَارَةً فَدَعَا الطُّنُونِ كَشَفَ كِتَابِهِ فِي مَرَارًا كِتَابٌ وَتَارَةً النَّفْعِ، كَثِيرُ الْحَجْمِ صَغِيرُ كِتَابٍ إِنَّهُ وَضَفِهِ فِي وَقَالَ الْقُدَمَاءِ اعْتَبَارَ عَلَى دَلِيلًا الْمُنْقُولَاتِ هَذِهِ وَكَفَى الْأُمَمِ. طَبَقَاتِ وَمَوْثُوقِهِ. لِلْكِتَابِ

#### تَوَظُّعُهُ

صَفِيحِي وَرَقٍ عَلَى الْفَارِسِيِّ بِالْقَلَمِ شَبِيهِ جَلِيٍّ بِخَطٍّ مَكْتُوبَةٍ وَهِيَ ذَهَبِيٌّ مُلَوَّنٌ وَرَقٍ بِجِلْدٍ مُثَقَّنًا تَجْلِيدًا وَمُجَلَّدَةً الصَّفْرَةَ إِلَى ضَارِبٍ مَعَ حَسَنَةٍ بِالْإِجْمَالِ وَالنُّسْخَةَ زِينَةً، مِثْلَهُمَا لِسَانٍ مَعَ الْوُجْهَيْنِ عَلَى فِي عَلَيْهَا فَتَبَّهْنَا أَكْثَرَهَا إِصْلَاحُ أَمَكْنَا الَّتِي الْأَغْلَاطِ مِنْ فِيهَا وَقَعَ مَا طَبَعْتَنَا. ذِيلُ

### English Translation

#### English Translation

*Kitab Tabaqat al-Umam* (The Book of the Categories of Nations) is one of the rare works in which an Arab writer describes the sciences among the nations that preceded his era. Although its author did not reach the level of Abu al-Faraj ibn al-Damimi in his *Fihrist*, he nevertheless collected numerous useful facts that demonstrate his research activity, his desire for knowledge, and his precision in observation. The people of al-Andalus used to boast of him and of the heads of the East.

Among those who knew this book in the East was Abu al-Faraj Grigorius ibn al-'Ibri, for he quoted from it in his *History of the Dynasties* two useful excerpts concerning the Arabs and their sciences. Likewise, al-Hajj Khalifa knew it and mentioned it several times in his *Kashf al-Zunun*: at one point calling it *Ta'rif bi-Tabaqat al-Umam*, and describing it as a small book of great benefit; at another point as *Kitab Tabaqat al-Umam*. These quotations suffice as proof of the esteem and trust the ancients had for this book.

#### Preface

The manuscript is written in a clear hand resembling Persian script, on thick paper tending toward yellow, and bound with skillful binding in colored gold paper on both sides with a matching tongue as ornament. The manuscript is, in general, fine despite the errors that occurred in it, most of which we were able to correct and have indicated in the notes to our edition.

“Sa’id ibn Ahmad ibn Abd al-Rahman ibn Muhammad ibn Sa’id al-Taghlabi, the judge with the kunya Abu al-Qasim, originally from Cordoba, transmitted from Abu Muhammad ibn Hazm, al-Fath ibn Qasim, Abu al-Walid al-Waqshi, and others. The amir Yahya ibn Dhi al-Nun appointed him as judge of Tulaytula (Toledo), and he was independent in his affairs and in testing judges by oath along with one witness in lawsuits and by testimony regarding handwriting, and judgments were made accordingly during his tenure. He was a man of knowledge, intelligence, and transmission. He was born in al-Mariyya (Almeria) in 420 AH (1039 CE) and died in Tulaytula while serving as its judge in Shawwal of the year 462 AH (1070 CE).”

The Book of the Categories of Nations

الْأُمَمِ طَبَقَاتِ كِتَابُ  
الْأَنْدَلُسِيِّ صَاعِدِ بْنِ أَحْمَدَ بْنِ صَاعِدِ الْقَاسِمِ أَبِي الْقَاضِي

Chapter One: The Ancient Nations

| العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | English Translation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>الرَّحِيمِ الرَّحْمَنِ اللَّهِ بِسْمِ<br/>يَسِّرْ رَبِّ</p> <p>تَعَالَى: اللَّهُ رَحِمَهُ صَاعِدِ بْنِ أَحْمَدَ بْنِ صَاعِدِ الْقَاسِمِ أَبُو الْقَاضِي قَالَ<br/>وَجَنُوبَهَا وَمَغَارِبَهَا الْأَرْضَ مَشَارِقَ فِي النَّاسِ جَمِيعَ أَنْ اعْلَمْ<br/>بِالْأَخْلَاقِ أَشْيَاءَ: بِثَلَاثَةِ يَتَمَيَّزُونَ وَاجِدًا نَوْعًا كَانُوا وَإِنْ وَشَمَالَهَا<br/>وَاللُّغَاتِ. وَالصُّورِ</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <p><i>In the name of God, the Merciful, the Compassionate.</i></p> <p><i>O Lord, make it easy!</i></p> <p>The judge Abu al-Qasim Sa'id ibn Ahmad ibn Sa'id—may God the Exalted have mercy on him—said: Know that all people in the East and West of the Earth, in its South and North, though they are one species, are distinguished by three things: by their moral character (<i>akhlāq</i>), their physical forms (<i>ṣuwar</i>), and their languages (<i>lughāt</i>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <p>العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ</p> <p>عَنْ وَفَحَصَ الْأَجْيَالِ سَائِرِ عَنْ وَبَحَثَ الْأُمَمِ بِأَخْبَارِ عُنِّي مَنْ وَرَعَمَ<br/>تَشَعَّبَ وَقَبْلَ الدُّهُورِ سَالِفِ فِي كَانُوا النَّاسِ أَنَّ الْفُرُونَ طَبَقَاتِ<br/>أُمَمٍ. سَبْعَ اللُّغَاتِ وَافْتِرَاقِ الْقَبَائِلِ</p> <p>الْفُرْسُ الْأُولَى □ □ الْأُمَّةُ</p> <p>فِي النَّبِيِّ الْجِبَالِ مِنْ بِلَادِهَا وَجِدَ الْمُعْمُورِ الْوَسْطِ فِي مَسْكَنِهَا وَكَانَ<br/>وَالدُّسْتُورُ وَالْكَرَجُ الْأَنْجَهَاتُ فِيهِ وَالَّذِي حُلْوَانَ بِعَقَبَةِ الْعِرَاقِ شِمَالِ<br/>الْمُتَّصِلِ وَالْبَابِ أَرْمِينِيَّةَ إِلَى الْبِلَادِ مِنْ وَغَيْرِهَا وَقَاشَانَ وَفَمَّ وَهَمْدَانَ<br/>وَالشَّابَرَانَ وَأَرْدَنَ وَالْبَيْلِقَانَ وَمَوْلَتَانَ وَطَبْرِسْتَانَ أَذْرَبِيْجَانَ بِبَحْرِ<br/>خُرَاسَانَ. بِلَادِ إِلَى وَجُرْجَانَ وَالطَّالِقَانَ وَالرَّيَّ</p> | <p>English Translation</p> <p>Those who have concerned themselves with the reports of nations and investigated the various generations, and examined the categories of ages, say that in earliest times, before the branching of tribes and the divergence of languages, there were seven nations.</p> <p><b>The First Nation: The Persians.</b></p> <p>Their dwelling was in the middle of the inhabited world. Their lands include the mountains in the north of Iraq, the region of Hulwan, and the area containing the Anjahat, Kuraj, Dustur, Hamadan, Qumm, Qashan, and other lands extending to Armenia, the Gate connecting to the Sea of Azerbaijan, Tabaristan, Multan, Bilaqan, Arzan, Shaboran, al-Rayy, Taliqan, and Jurjan, to the lands of Khurasan.</p> |

## Chapter Two: Science in India

## العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

الْهِنْدُ فِي الْعِلْمِ

فَلَمْ نَأْلَفْهُمْ فَلَمْ وَبَيْنَهُمْ بَيْنَنَا الْمَالِكِ وَاعْتِرَاضِ بِلَادِنَا مِنَ الْهِنْدِ وَلِبَعْدِ  
وَلَا مَذَاهِبِهِمْ مِنْ تُبْدٍ إِلَّا عَلَيْنَا وَرَدَتْ وَلَا غُلُومِهِمْ مِنْ طَرَفٍ إِلَيْنَا نَصِلُ  
عِلْمِهِمْ. مِنْ بِالْقَلِيلِ إِلَّا سَمِعْنَا

عَنْهُمْ الْمَشْهُورَةُ الثَّلَاثَةُ الْمَذْهَبُ الْجُومِ عُلُومِ فِي الْهِنْدِ مَذَاهِبُ فَمِنْ  
يَصِلُ وَلَمْ الْأَرْكَندِ وَمَذْهَبُ الْأَزْدِيحِ وَمَذْهَبُ هِنْدِ السُّنْدِ مَذْهَبُ وَهُوَ  
الَّذِي الْمَذْهَبُ وَهُوَ هِنْدِ السُّنْدِ مَذْهَبُ إِلَّا التَّحْصِيلِ عَلَى مِنْهُمْ إِلَيْنَا  
إِبْرَاهِيمَ بْنِ كَمَحَمَدِ الْأَزْيَاجِ فِيهِ وَالْفَوَائِدِ الْإِسْلَامِ مِنْ جَمَاعَةٍ تَقْلَدُهُ  
الْخَوَارِزْمِيِّ مُوسَى بْنِ وَمُحَمَّدِ الْبَغْدَادِيِّ اللَّهُ عَبْدُ بْنُ وَحَبِشِ الْفَرَازِيِّ  
السُّنْدِ وَتَفْسِيرُ وَغَيْرِهِمْ. الْأَدَمِيِّ بِابْنِ الْمَعْرُوفِ مُحَمَّدِ بْنِ وَالْحُسَيْنِ  
الدَّاهِرِ. الدَّاهِرُ هِنْدِ

فَصْلٌ

فَإِنَّ الْعَالَمَ مَدَّةٌ عَدَدٌ لَا أَنْ وَافَقُوا فَإِنَّهُمْ هِنْدِ السُّنْدِ أَصْحَابُ وَأَمَّا  
مُجْتَمِعَتِ وَجُوزَهَرَاتِهَا وَأَوْجَاتِهَا الْكَوَاكِبِ أَنْ ذَكَرُواهَا النَّبِيُّ مَذْهَبُهُمْ  
وَالْأَوْجَاتِ الْكَوَاكِبِ حَرَكَاتٌ أَبَدًا الْأَمْرُ ذَلِكَ فَمَنْذُ الْحَمَلِ رَأْسُ فِي  
طَوِيلًا دَهْرًا خَرَابًا السُّفْلَى الْعَالَمِ وَبَقِيَ الْأَرْضِ فِي وَالْجُوزَهَرَاتِ  
كَانَ فَإِذَا الْبُرُوجِ فِي وَالْجُوزَهَرَاتِ وَالْأَوْجَاتِ الْكَوَاكِبِ تَتَفَرَّقُ حَتَّى  
غَبَرَ إِلَى أَبَدًا هَكَذَا الْأَوَّلِ الْأَمْرُ إِلَى السُّفْلَى الْعَالَمِ حَالَهُ بَدَأَتْ كَذَلِكَ  
عِنْدَهُمْ. غَايَةُ

## English Translation

## English Translation

## Science in India

Because of the distance of India from our lands and the obstacles between us and them, we have not become familiar with them. No portion of their sciences has reached us, nothing has come to us but fragments of their doctrines, and we have heard only a little of their knowledge.

Among the doctrines of the Indians in the science of astrology, three doctrines are famous: the doctrine of *Sindhind*, the doctrine of the *Azij*, and the doctrine of *Arkand*. Only the doctrine of *Sindhind* has reached us in a complete form. It was followed by a group of Muslims, and those who established it were the compilers of astronomical tables (*al-azyāj*), such as Muhammad ibn Ibrahim al-Fazari, Habash ibn Abd Allah al-Baghdadi, Muhammad ibn Musa al-Khwarizmi, al-Husayn ibn Muhammad known as Ibn al-Adami, and others. The interpretation of *Sindhind* is “the Eternal Time” (*al-Dahr al-Dahir*).

## [Section]

As for the followers of *Sindhind*, they agree that the duration of the world has no fixed number. Their doctrine is that the planets, their apogees, and their nodes were all gathered at the head of Aries. Since that event, the movements of the planets, apogees, and nodes began. The lower world remained desolate for a long time until the planets, apogees, and nodes dispersed through the zodiac signs. When that happened, the condition of the lower world returned to its first state, and this continues without end according to them.

## Chapter Three: Science among the Persians

## الْعَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

## الْعَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

## الْفُرْسُ فِي الْعِلْمِ

الشَّامِخَ وَالْعِزَّ الْبَازِخَ الشَّرَفَ فَأَهْلُ الْفُرْسِ وَهِيَ الثَّانِيَةُ الْأُمَّةُ وَأَمَّا أُمَّةٌ نَعْلَمُ وَلَا مَلُوكًا وَأَنْوَسَهَا أَقْلِيَمًا وَأَشْرَفَهَا دَارًا الْأُمَمِ وَأَوْسَطَ ثَحَامِي وَرُؤُوسَ تَجْمَعُهُمْ مُلُوكٌ لَهُمْ وَكَانَتْ الْمُلْكُ لَهَا دَامَ غَيْرُهُمْ مَظْلُومُهُمْ عَنْ ظَالِمِهِمْ وَتَدَفَّعَ غَارَهُمْ مِنْ يَهُمْ وَتَغْلِبَ نَاوَاهُمْ مَنْ عَنْهُمْ وَأَحْسَنَ وَدَوَامِ اتِّصَالٍ عَلَى حَظِّهِمْ فِيهِ مَا عَلَى الْأُمُورِ مِنْ وَتَحْتَمِلُهُمُ التَّنْظِيمُ.

## وَالْعَجَمُ فِي الْعَرَبِ فِي

الْأَذِنِ بْنِ أَمِيمِ بْنِ كَيْثُمُورْتِ مُلْكِ ابْتِدَاءٍ مِنْ أَنَّ ذَلِكَ فِي قِيلَ مَا وَأَصَحُّ عَنْدهُمْ هُوَ الَّذِي كَانَهُمُ الْفُرْسُ مَنُوشَهَرَ مُلْكُ إِلَى نُوحِ ابْنِ سَامِ بْنِ الطَّبَقَةِ مُلُوكِ أَوَّلِ مَنُوشَهَرَ مُلْكِ ابْتِدَاءٍ إِلَى السَّلَامِ عَلَيْهِ الْبَشَرِ أَبُو آدَمَ إِلَى مَنُوشَهَرَ مُلْكِ وَمِنْ كَامِلَةٍ سَنَةِ أَلْفِ نَحْوِ الْفُرْسِ مُلُوكِ مِنَ الثَّانِيَةِ الْفُرْسِ مُلُوكِ مِنَ الثَّلَاثَةِ الطَّبَقَةِ مُلُوكِ أَوَّلِ دُوعَ بْنِ كَيْثُبَادَ مُلْكِ ابْتِدَاءِ الطَّوَائِفِ مُلْكِ ابْتِدَاءٍ إِلَى كَيْثُبَادَ مُلْكِ وَمِنْ عَامٍ مَاثْنِي مِنْ قَرِيبِ الْإِسْكَندَرِ مَقْتَلٍ عِنْدَ ذَلِكَ الْفُرْسِ مُلُوكِ مِنَ الرَّابِعَةِ الطَّبَقَةِ وَهِيَ سَنَةِ أَلْفِ نَحْوِ الثَّلَاثَةِ الطَّبَقَةِ مُلُوكِ آخِرِ دَارَا بْنِ لِدَارَا

## English Translation

## English Translation

## Science among the Persians

As for the second nation, the Persians: they are a people of towering nobility and exalted glory, the most settled of nations and the noblest in region, and the most prosperous in kings. We know of no nation besides them whose sovereignty endured so long, who had kings that united them and leaders that defended them from those who opposed them, overcame with them those who envied them, and protected their oppressed from their oppressors, and who endured affairs in a way that secured their portion with continuity and permanence and the finest organization.

## [On the Arabs and the Non-Arabs]

The most correct opinion on this is that from the beginning of the reign of Kayumars ibn Amim ibn Aladh ibn Sam ibn Nuh (Noah) to the reign of Manushihir the Persian—who is, according to them, Adam the father of mankind, peace be upon him—to the beginning of the reign of Manushihir, the first king of the second *tabaqa* (class) of Persian kings, was about a thousand complete years. From the reign of Manushihir to the beginning of the reign of Kaythubadh ibn Dua, the first king of the third *tabaqa* of Persian kings, was about two hundred years. From the reign of Kaythubadh to the beginning of the reign of the Tribes (*al-Tawa'if*), the fourth *tabaqa* of Persian kings, at the killing of Alexander of Dara ibn Dara, the last king of the third *tabaqa* of Persian kings, was about a thousand years.



## Chapter Four: Science in Greece

### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

اليوناني في العلم

وَالْأُمَمُ وَقِسْطَنْطِينِيَّةَ وَالرُّومَ فَلَسْطِينَ أَهْلُ فَهَمُ الْيُونَانِيُّونَ وَأَمَّا  
الْمَتَوَسِّطُ بَحْرٍ شَطٌّ مِنْ مَمْتَدَّةٍ مُلْكِهِمْ دَارَةٌ وَكَانَتْ بِهَا. الْمُحِيطَةُ  
بَحْرٍ إِلَى الْقُطْبِ أَقْصَى وَمِنْ الْمَغَارِبِ، فِي شَطِّهِ إِلَى الْمَشَارِقِ فِي  
دَوْلَتِهِمْ وَكَانَتْ الْإِسْكَنْدَرِيَّةُ. مَدِينَةُ الْعُظْمَى مَدِينَتُهُمْ وَكَانَتْ الشَّامُ.  
مُتَنَوِّعَةً. كَثِيرَةً وَعُلُومُهُمْ جَدًّا قَدِيمَةً

وَأَفْلَاطُونُ قَالِيَسُ عِنْدَهُمْ وَالْحَكَمِ الْعُلُومِ فِي تَكَلَّمَ مِنْ أَوَّلٍ وَكَانَ  
وَأَفْلِيدُسُ وَبَرْقَلِيَسُ وَهَبَاطِيَا وَجَالِيئُوسُ وَبَطْلِيمُوسُ وَأَرْسَطُو  
أَهْلٍ مِنْ هَؤُلَاءِ إِلَى يُنْسَبُ مِنْ وَجَمِيعِ وَأَرْشَمِيدُسُ وَنِقُومَاخُسُ  
وَتَوْضِيحُهَا الْعُلُومِ أَصُولٍ بِإِصْلَاحِ قَامُوا الَّذِينَ وَهُمْ وَالْحَكَمِ. الْعُلُومِ  
بَلَّغَتْهُمْ. ذَلِكَ فِي مَوْلَفَاتِهِمْ وَكَانَتْ قَوَاعِدُهَا وَتَقْيِيدُ أَقْسَامِهَا وَتَرْتِيبُ  
أَهْلٍ وَاتَّخَذَهَا الْمَنَازِرَةَ نَشَرَهَا أَنْ بَعْدَ الْعَرَبِ لُغَةً إِلَى نُفِلَتْ إِنَّمَا ثُمَّ  
الْشَّرْقِ. فِي النَّصَارَى مِنَ الدِّينِ

### English Translation

English Translation

Science in Greece

As for the Greeks, they are the people of Palestine, Rome, Constantinople, and the surrounding nations. Their kingdom extended from the shore of the Mediterranean Sea in the East to its shore in the West, and from the far north to the Syrian Sea. Their greatest city was the city of Alexandria. Their state was very ancient and their sciences were many and varied.

The first to discourse on the sciences and wisdom (*hikma*) among them were Thales, Plato, Aristotle, Ptolemy, Galen, Hippocrates, Proclus, Euclid, Nicomachus, Archimedes, and all those attributed to these in the sciences and wisdom. They were the ones who established the principles of the sciences, elucidated them, arranged their parts, and codified their rules, and their compositions on this were in their own language. Then they were translated into Arabic after the *al-Manadhirah* disseminated them and the religious scholars among the Christians in the East adopted them.

## Chapter Five: Science in Egypt

### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

#### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

#### مِصْرَ فِي الْعِلْمِ

وَلَكِنَّهَا نَافِعَةٌ قَدِيمَةٌ غُلُومُهُمْ وَكَانَتْ الْعِلْمُ مِصْرَ أَهْلُ فَهْمُ الْقِبْطِ وَأَمَّا  
الَّذِي الْمَلِكُ بَطْلِيمُوسَ عَهْدٍ فِي مِنْهُمْ الْيُونَانِيُّونَ أَخَذَتْهَا مِنْذُ تَبْلُغَ لَمْ  
الْعُلَمَاءُ إِلَيْهَا وَحَشَدَ لِلْعُلُومِ مَوْطِنًا وَجَعَلَهَا الْإِسْكَندَرِيَّةَ مَدِينَةً بَنَى  
حِكْمٍ مِنْ فِيهَا فَأَدْخَلُوا غُلُومَهُمُ الْقِبْطِ عَنْ فَأَخَذُوا الْأُمَمَ جَمِيعٍ مِنْ  
الْهَيْئَةِ عِلْمٌ ذَلِكَ وَمِنْ فِيهَا. وَصَنَفُوا وَنَقَّحُوا إِلَيْهَا أَضَافَ مَا الْيُونَانِ  
الْعُلُومِ. مِنْ ذَلِكَ وَغَيْرِ وَالْأَدْوِيَّةِ الْعِلَالِ وَعِلْمُ الْكَوَاكِبِ تَأْلِيفٍ وَعِلْمُ

### English Translation

#### English Translation

#### Science in Egypt

As for the Copts, they are the people of Upper Egypt. Their sciences were ancient and beneficial, but they did not advance further since the Greeks took them from them in the time of Ptolemy the king who built the city of Alexandria and made it a center for the sciences, gathering scholars from all nations. They took from the Copts their sciences and incorporated into them Greek wisdom, adding to them, refining them, and composing works on them. Among these were the science of astronomy (*'ilm al-hay'a*), the science of the configuration of the planets, the science of causes and remedies (medicine), and other sciences.

## Chapter Six: Science among the Jews

## العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

## العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

## الْيَهُودُ فِي الْعِلْمِ

أَنْبِيَائِهِمْ زَمَنَ فِي الْأُولَى أَزْمِنْتِهِمْ فِي عُلُومَ لَهُمْ كَانَتْ فَقَدْ الْيَهُودُ وَأَمَّا الْعَجَمُ بِلَادٍ فِي وَتَفَرَّقُوا بِلَادِهِمْ مِنْ خَرَجُوا لَمَّا إِنَّهُمْ ثُمَّ وَمُلُوكِهِمْ. وَلَا بَقَاءَ أَهْلٍ يَكُونُوا لَمْ لِأَنَّهُمْ وَتَنَكَّرَتْ عُلُومُهُمْ ضَاعَتْ وَالْعَرَبُ عُلُومًا الْأَنْبِيَاءِ تَوَارِثَ مِنْ حَفِظُوا قَدْ وَلَكِنَّهُمْ الْعِلْمِ. عَلَى مُوَاطَنَةِ مُوسَى عُلَمَائِهِمْ أَشْهَرُ مِنْ وَكَانَ وَالْتَّوْحِيدِ. وَالشَّرَائِعِ التَّعَبُّدِ فِي وَالطَّبِّ وَالْفَلَسَفَةِ الْكَلَامِ عِلْمٍ فِي صَنَفَ الَّذِي الْأَنْدَلُسِيِّ مَيِّمُونَ بَنُ وَغَيْرَهَا.

## English Translation

## English Translation

## Science among the Jews

As for the Jews, they had sciences in their earliest times, in the era of their prophets and kings. But when they left their lands and dispersed into the lands of the non-Arabs and the Arabs, their sciences were lost and forgotten because they were not a people of endurance or perseverance in science. However, they did preserve from the inheritance of the prophets sciences concerning worship (*'ibādāt*), religious laws (*sharā'i*), and monotheism (*tawhīd*). Among their most famous scholars was Musa ibn Maymun (Moses Maimonides) al-Andalusi, who composed works on the science of theology (*kalām*), philosophy (*falsafa*), medicine (*tibb*), and other subjects.

## Chapter Seven: Science among the Arabs

### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

#### العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

#### العَرَبُ فِي الْعِلْمِ

مِنْهُمْ الْبَادِيَّةُ وَكَانَتْ حَاضِرَةً. وَأُمَّةٌ بَادِيَّةٌ أُمَّةٌ أَمْتَانِ: فَهُمُ الْعَرَبُ وَأَمَّا الْبِلَادُ. فِي وَتَنَقَّلَهُمْ مَعِيشَتُهُمْ لِيَصْغُرَ عَلَيْهِ تَوَاطُبٌ وَلَا بِالْعِلْمِ تَعْنَى لَا وَالنُّجُومِ الطَّبِّ فِي الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ فِي عُلُومٍ لَهُمْ كَانَتْ فَقَدْ الْحَاضِرَةُ وَأَمَّا فِي وَشَرَعَ الْإِسْلَامُ جَاءَ لَمَّا ثُمَّ ذَلِكَ. وَغَيْرِ وَالنَّحْوِ وَالشَّعْرِ وَالسَّحْرِ فِي الْعَرَبِ اجْتَهَدَ وَالْفَلَاحَ لِلنَّجَاةِ سَبَبًا وَجَعَلَهُ عَلَيْهِ وَحَثَّ الْعِلْمَ طَلَبَ حَتَّى الْعَرَبُ بِلُغَةٍ وَتَضْيِيرَهَا الْأُخْرَى الْأُمَمِ مِنْ وَتَقْلِيهَا الْعُلُومَ طَلَبَ وَفَقُنُونِ. عُلُومٍ أَهْلٌ قَلِيلٌ زَمَنٍ فِي أَصْبَحُوا

وَالْتَفْسِيرِ وَالْحَدِيثِ وَالْفِقْهِ الْكَلَامِ عِلْمٌ إِلَيْهِ نَشَطُوا مَا أَوَّلَ وَكَانَ وَأَضَافُوا فِيهَا وَصَنَّفُوا فَتَقَلَّوْهَا الْأَوَائِلَ لِعُلُومٍ تَعَرَّضُوا إِنَّهُمْ ثُمَّ النُّجُومِ عِلْمٌ فِي الْعَرَبِ أَشْهَرُ مِنْ وَكَانَ كَثِيرَةً. أَشْيَاءٌ إِلَيْهَا وَابْنُ الرَّازِيِّ الطَّبِّ وَفِي الْفَلَكِيِّ. مَعْشَرٌ وَأَبُو وَالْبَتَّانِيُّ الْفَرْغَانِيُّ الْمَجْرُطِيُّ بَطْلِيمُوسُ الْهَيْئَةِ وَفِي رَشْدٍ. وَابْنُ وَالْمَجُوسِيِّ سَيْنَا الْحَوَارِزْمِيُّ الْحَسَبِ الْعِلْمِ وَفِي الطُّوسِيِّ. الدِّينَ وَشَرَفَ وَالْبِثْرُوجِي رَشْدٍ. وَابْنُ سَيْنَا وَابْنُ وَالْفَارَابِيُّ الْكُنْدِيُّ الْفَلَسَفَةِ وَفِي وَالْكَشِّي.

### English Translation

#### English Translation

#### Science among the Arabs

As for the Arabs, they are two nations: a desert nation (*bādiya*) and a settled nation (*hādara*). The desert among them did not concern itself with science nor persevere in it due to the hardship of their livelihood and their movement from land to land. As for the settled people, they had sciences in the Jahili period in medicine (*tibb*), astrology (*nujūm*), magic (*sihr*), poetry (*shi'r*), grammar (*nahw*), and other subjects. Then when Islam came and legislated the pursuit of knowledge, encouraged it, and made it a means of salvation and success, the Arabs strove in seeking the sciences, translating them from other nations, and rendering them into Arabic, until in a short time they became a people of sciences and arts.

The first [sciences] they were active in were theology (*kalām*), jurisprudence (*fiqh*), *hadith*, and Qur'anic exegesis (*tafsir*). Then they turned to the sciences of the ancients (*'ulūm al-awā'il*), translating them, composing works on them, and adding much to them. Among the most famous Arabs in the science of astrology were al-Farghani, al-Battani, and Abu Ma'shar the astronomer. In medicine: al-Razi, Ibn Sina (Avicenna), al-Majusi, and Ibn Rushd (Averroes). In astronomy (*hay'a*): Ptolemy al-Majriti, al-Bitruji (Alpetragius), and Sharaf al-Din al-Tusi. In arithmetic (*hisāb*): al-Khwarizmi and al-Kashshi. In philosophy (*falsafa*): al-Kindi, al-Farabi, Ibn Sina, and Ibn Rushd.

## Editorial and Scholarly Notes

## العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

## العَرَبِيُّ النَّصُّ

الكتاب مقسم إلى قسمين رئيسيين:

القسم الأول: "الأمم القديمة" (al-Umam al-Qadima) ويتناول سبعة أمم: العرب، الفرس، الروم، الأندلس، صقلية، مصر، وبلاد الرافدين. القسم الثاني: "الأمم الإسلامية" (al-Umam al-Islamiyya) ويتناول فئات من العلماء في مجالات مختلفة: الطبقات = categories / classes / ranks، الأمم = nations / peoples، العلوم = sciences / knowledge، الحكمة = wisdom / philosophy، رياضيات = mathematics.

الكتاب مقسم إلى قسمين رئيسيين:

القسم الأول: "الأمم القديمة" (al-Umam al-Qadima): سبعة أمم. (١) العرب، الفرس، الروم، الأندلس، صقلية، مصر، وبلاد الرافدين. (٢) الأمم الإسلامية (al-Umam al-Islamiyya): فئات من العلماء.

الكتاب مقسم إلى قسمين رئيسيين:

طَبَقَات = categories / classes / ranks

أُمَم = nations / peoples

عُلُوم = sciences / knowledge

حِكْمَة = wisdom / philosophy

رِيَاضِيَّات = mathematics

الكتاب مقسم إلى قسمين رئيسيين:

القسم الأول: "الأمم القديمة" (al-Umam al-Qadima): سبعة أمم.

1. العرب، الفرس، الروم، الأندلس، صقلية، مصر، وبلاد الرافدين. القسم الثاني: "الأمم الإسلامية" (al-Umam al-Islamiyya): فئات من العلماء.

2. الأمم الإسلامية (al-Umam al-Islamiyya): فئات من العلماء. القسم الثالث: "الأمم الحديثة" (al-Umam al-Haditha): فئات من العلماء.

3. الأمم الحديثة (al-Umam al-Haditha): فئات من العلماء. Science in the Medieval World. القسم الرابع: "الأمم المعاصرة" (al-Umam al-Mu'asira): فئات من العلماء.

4. الأمم المعاصرة (al-Umam al-Mu'asira): فئات من العلماء. القسم الخامس: "الأمم المستقبلية" (al-Umam al-Mustaqbaliyya): فئات من العلماء.

## English Translation

## English Translation

## On the Author

The judge (*qāḍī*) of Toledo, Abu al-Qasim Sa'id ibn Ahmad ibn Sa'id al-Taghlabi. Born in Almeria (*al-Mariyya*) in 420 AH / 1039 CE. Died in Shawwal 462 AH / 1070 CE. He composed this work around 460 AH / 1068 CE.

## On the Work

The *Kitab Tabaqat al-Umam* is divided into two main parts: (1) **The Ancient Nations** (*al-Umam al-Qadima*): Seven nations. (2) **The Islamic Nations** (*al-Umam al-Islamiyya*): Classes of scholars.

## Key Technical Terms

*tabaqāt* (طَبَقَات) = categories / classes / ranks

*umam* (أُمَم) = nations / peoples

*'ulūm* (عُلُوم) = sciences / knowledge

*hikma* (حِكْمَة) = wisdom / philosophy

*riyāḍiyyāt* (رِيَاضِيَّات) = mathematics

## Bibliography

## Editions and Translations:

- Cheikh, L. (ed.). *Kitab Tabaqat al-Umam* by Sa'id al-Andalusi. Beirut: al-Matba'a al-Kathulikiyya, 1912.
- Bu'a 'Alwan, M. 'A. *Sa'id al-Andalusi: Tabaqat al-Umam*. Damascus: Dar al-Fikr, 1996.
- Salem, S. I. and Kumar, A. (trans.). *Science in the Medieval World: Book of the Categories of Nations*. Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991.
- Vernet, J. "Sa'id al-Andalusi." In *Dictionary of Scientific Biography*, vol. 12, pp. 76–77.

## Note on the Bilingual Edition

This parallel-text edition presents the Arabic original of the Cheikh 1912 edition alongside an English translation. The translation preserves technical terminology in transliterated form with explanatory notes. The seven-fold classification of nations reflects the anthropological and geographical knowledge of 11th-century al-Andalus.

End of Bilingual Edition

الْمُرَدَّجَةُ النُّسخةُ نِهَائِيَّةٌ